Great Indian Bustard Conservation

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- The Great Indian Bustard is a critically endangered bird that depends on **open grasslands** and semi-arid landscapes. Its survival requires suitable breeding grounds, food availability and protection from disturbance. Conservation therefore involves maintaining the ecological conditions necessary for the species to reproduce.

- Grassland habitats face pressure from agricultural expansion, infrastructure development and **changing land use**. Although tree planting is often associated with environmental improvement, converting natural grasslands into wooded areas can harm species adapted to open landscapes.

- **Overhead power lines** create serious risks for large flying birds such as the Great Indian Bustard. Collisions can cause deaths even when surrounding habitats remain suitable. Measures such as underground cabling in priority areas and appropriate bird-diversion devices can reduce these threats.

- **Captive breeding** can help increase the population of a threatened species, but releasing birds without protecting their natural habitats may not produce lasting recovery. Successful conservation requires scientific monitoring, habitat restoration, cooperation with local communities and action against continuing environmental threats.

Great Indian Bustard conservation requires protecting natural grasslands, reducing infrastructure-related mortality and combining captive breeding with long-term habitat management.